

FOUR SIGNS YOU HAVEN'T FOUND IT YET

A companion resource for The Surface Pattern — read this before you start your coaching session.

BEFORE YOUR COACHING SESSION

Read these before you start. They describe the four most common ways the session goes sideways — and how to correct each one in the moment.

THE FOUR RED FLAGS

01

YOUR COACH ASKS “WHY.”

RED FLAG

Stop it. “*This sounds like abandonment issues*” is interpretation. Today is *what*, not *why*. Tell it to stay in observer mode.

02

YOU ONLY HAVE ONE OR TWO EXAMPLES.

RED FLAG

Keep digging. You haven't found a pattern yet. You've found a moment.

03

YOUR DESCRIPTION SOUNDS LIKE A LABEL.

RED FLAG

“*Guarded,*” “*controlling,*” “*anxious*” — push past it. What does guarded actually look like? What specific actions would you film?

04

YOUR COACH IS DOING MOST OF THE TALKING.

RED FLAG

Your adaptive unconscious is the source here. The coach should be asking questions. You should be answering them.

IF YOU CATCH ONE OF THESE

None of these mean the session has gone wrong. They mean you're standing right at the edge of the first answer — the safest one. Correct it in the moment, and keep going.

*The coach asks. You answer. You watch.
That's the whole session.*

STAY IN OBSERVER MODE. KEEP DIGGING.